

Invoice implementation plan — synthetic format example

Strategy and implementation blueprint

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Industry: Business operations | Language: English | Selected option: balanced

Proposed implementation design. Validate evidence, estimates and unresolved risks before approval.

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1. Executive summary

The bottleneck is duplicate entry, not reasoning complexity.

Evidence / assumptions: Proposed design / advisory analysis; validate against the evidence register.

2. Original request and underlying problem

Reduce duplicate invoice entry using validated records.

- Normalized problem: Duplicate entry between disconnected tools
- Requested solution: Use AI for invoices

3. Business context, objectives and success definition

The operations team processes invoices.

4. Evidence register and confidence policy

Source-backed facts are attributed below. Proposed designs are recommendations, inferred assumptions are not confirmed facts, and estimates are planning ranges. Unknown facts, vendor access and applicable regulations require validation. Readiness scores are advisory heuristics.

Evidence / assumptions: User messages and uploaded documents. No independent verification is implied.

Source register

Category	Fact	Source
workflow	Manual duplicate invoice entry.	Synthetic user message

5. Stakeholders and current system

Operations staff wants less duplicate entry; the reviewer needs a clear approval trail; the owner needs reconciled records.

Evidence / assumptions: Synthetic fixture: proposed design based on manual invoice entry; integration, rates and dates require validation.

Stakeholders and personas

Design aspect	Detail
Operations staff	Upload records, correct errors and view assigned imports.
Reviewer	Approve exports; cannot change payment permissions.

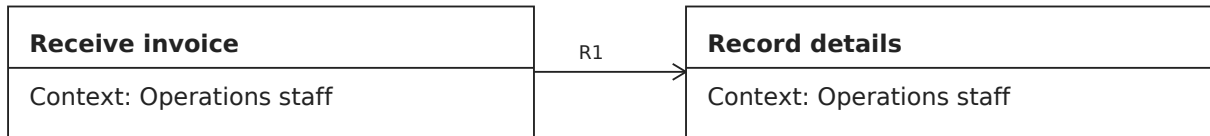
People, process, technology and data

Aspect	Current state
People	Operations staff
Process	Copy invoice details, review, then import.
Technology	Email; Spreadsheet
Data	Invoice records

6. Current-state workflow

Copy invoice details, review, then import.

Current-state process map



R1. Receive invoice — Record details: Next step

Current activities

Step / owner	Activity / tools
1. Receive invoice — Operations staff	Read incoming email. Tools: Email
2. Record details — Operations staff	Retype invoice details. Tools: Spreadsheet

7. Bottlenecks, gaps and root causes

Duplicate entry between disconnected tools

Duplicate entry

Analysis	Detail
Finding	Staff retype the same invoice data.
Evidence	User message: invoices copied from email to spreadsheet.
Confidence	90% advisory

8. Validation gaps and unanswered questions

Resolve these items with the named stakeholders before committing to implementation.

- API access requires validation.
- Confirm accounting CSV format, retention period, baseline volume and rates.

9. AI necessity and automation opportunities

Automate validated imports with human exception review.

- Decision: AUTOMATION_SUFFICIENT · AI necessity 15/100 · confidence 85%
- The supplied workflow follows fixed rules.
- Non-AI alternative: Validate and import structured invoice records using deterministic rules.

10. Three solution options

Compare scope, cost, delivery and operating trade-offs before selecting the implementation path.

Lean: Lean process pilot

Comparison field	Option detail
Problem coverage / included scope	Standardize spreadsheet entry and review.
Excluded	Automated payments AI extraction
AI usage	none: Fixed fields and explicit validation rules do not need AI.
Technology / implementation	Configure the existing spreadsheet and a review checklist.
Integrations / data	Accounting import format and credentials require validation.
Security / privacy / governance	Role-limited access and audit records; jurisdiction and retention require validation.
Team / ownership	Operations owner approves rules; delivery engineer implements the pilot.
Benefits / outcomes	Reduce duplicate entry and make exception handling visible.
Limitations / trade-offs	Manual retyping remains
Risks / mitigations	Unverified integration: validate CSV format and reconcile a sample before rollout.
Scalability	One team
Best fit	Very limited budget
Do not select when	Volume makes manual entry impractical
Effort estimate	3–5 person-days. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: low. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.
Cost estimate	Unknown — requires validation. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: unknown. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.
Delivery range	1–2 weeks. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: low. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.

Balanced: Balanced import workflow

Comparison field	Option detail
Problem coverage / included scope	Add a validated invoice import service with human review.
Excluded	Automated payments AI extraction
AI usage	none: Fixed fields and explicit validation rules do not need AI.
Technology / implementation	Small deterministic importer with a relational audit store.
Integrations / data	Accounting import format and credentials require validation.
Security / privacy / governance	Role-limited access and audit records; jurisdiction and retention require validation.
Team / ownership	Operations owner approves rules; delivery engineer implements the pilot.
Benefits / outcomes	Reduce duplicate entry and make exception handling visible.
Limitations / trade-offs	Requires a maintained import service
Risks / mitigations	Unverified integration: validate CSV format and reconcile a sample before rollout.
Scalability	Several teams with bounded imports
Best fit	Repeatable invoice workload
Do not select when	No engineering owner is available
Effort estimate	10–20 person-days. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: low. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.
Cost estimate	Unknown — requires validation. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: unknown. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.
Delivery range	3–6 weeks. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: low. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.

Advanced: Advanced integration platform

Comparison field	Option detail
Problem coverage / included scope	Introduce a multi-team integration platform and stronger governance.
Excluded	Automated payments AI extraction
AI usage	none: Fixed fields and explicit validation rules do not need AI.
Technology / implementation	Central integration runtime with separate work queues and managed identity.
Integrations / data	Accounting import format and credentials require validation.
Security / privacy / governance	Role-limited access and audit records; jurisdiction and retention require validation.
Team / ownership	Operations owner approves rules; delivery engineer implements the pilot.
Benefits / outcomes	Reduce duplicate entry and make exception handling visible.
Limitations / trade-offs	Higher operational burden
Risks / mitigations	Unverified integration: validate CSV format and reconcile a sample before rollout.
Scalability	Multi-team governance
Best fit	Many systems and large transaction volumes
Do not select when	Current scale cannot justify additional infrastructure
Effort estimate	30–60 person-days. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: low. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.
Cost estimate	Unknown — requires validation. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: unknown. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.
Delivery range	8–14 weeks. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: low. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.

11. Option comparison and weighted decision matrix

Weights total 100%. Scores run from 1 (weakest fit) to 5 (best fit). Total = $\text{sum}(\text{weight} \times \text{score}) \div 5$, calculated by shift.AI. Scores and assumed priorities require stakeholder validation.

Weighted scores

Criterion / weight	Lean	Balanced	Advanced
Business fit (40%)	2	5	4
Cost fit (30%)	5	4	1
Time to value (30%)	5	4	2
Total / 100	76.0	88.0	50.0

Business fit

Decision basis	Explanation
Weight basis	Assumed priority: confirm with operations owner.
Lean	2/5 — Advisory fit for a small operations team.
Balanced	5/5 — Advisory fit for a small operations team.
Advanced	4/5 — Advisory fit for a small operations team.

Cost fit

Decision basis	Explanation
Weight basis	Assumed priority: confirm with operations owner.
Lean	5/5 — Advisory fit for a small operations team.
Balanced	4/5 — Advisory fit for a small operations team.
Advanced	1/5 — Advisory fit for a small operations team.

Time to value

Decision basis	Explanation
Weight basis	Assumed priority: confirm with operations owner.
Lean	5/5 — Advisory fit for a small operations team.
Balanced	4/5 — Advisory fit for a small operations team.
Advanced	2/5 — Advisory fit for a small operations team.

12. Recommended option and rejected alternatives

Balanced: Balances removal of duplicate entry with manageable delivery effort.

- A simpler invoice workflow: Replace duplicate entry with reviewed imports.
- Solution type: CUSTOM_AUTOMATION · Complexity: LOW
- Lean rejected: Retains manual retyping.
- Advanced rejected: Scale and governance burden are not justified.
- Decision sensitivity: Choose lean if no engineer can maintain the importer.

13. Detailed scope and acceptance criteria

Import validated invoice rows, detect duplicates and require review before accounting export.

Detailed scope and acceptance criteria

Design aspect	Detail
REQ-1	Reject duplicate supplier/reference pairs; preserve a reason for every rejected row.
Out of scope	Do not automate payments or infer invoice fields using AI.

14. Technology stack and rationale

Use deterministic validation and a small persistent audit trail; verify existing hosting before choosing a vendor.

Technology stack and rationale

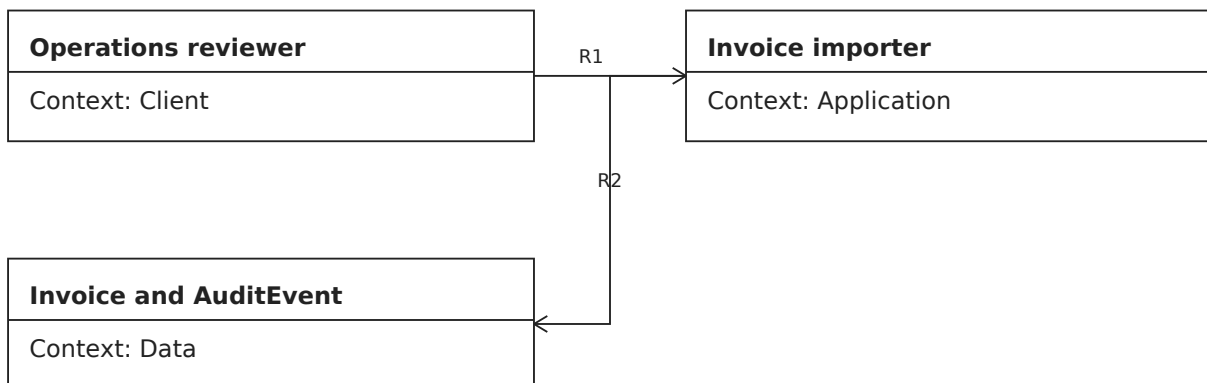
Design aspect	Detail
Backend	Python service: simple CSV validation; alternative is existing accounting import configuration.
Data store	Relational audit store; use the current supported database if available.
Identity	Reuse the organization identity provider if accessible; do not assume it exists.

15. High-level architecture

Operations supplies structured invoices to the Invoice importer, reviews exceptions, then approves the accounting handoff.

- Data flow: Invoice arrives
- Data flow: Validate fields
- Data flow: Human approves
- Data flow: Import accounting record

High-level architecture



R1. Operations reviewer — Invoice importer: Upload and approve

R2. Invoice importer — Invoice and AuditEvent: Validate and audit

Reviewed solution components

Component	Responsibility / rationale
Invoice importer	Validate and import structured records. Why: Fields follow deterministic rules. (Non-AI component)

16. Low-level component design

Invoice importer owns parsing, field checks, deduplication and export audit. Human approval precedes external changes.

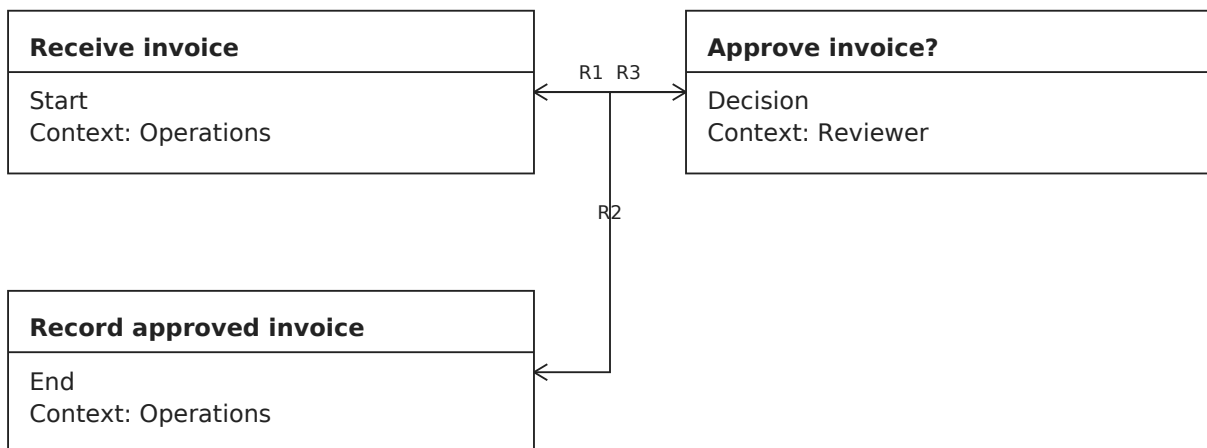
Low-level component design

Design aspect	Detail
Input / output	CSV invoice rows -> accepted rows, exception report and approved export.
Business rule	Unique supplier/reference; required amount and date; reject malformed rows.
Failure / security	Reject malformed imports atomically, audit attempt, require reviewer permission.

17. Future-state workflow and approval flows

Upload records, validate fields and duplicates, resolve exceptions, review and approve export, then reconcile the result.

Future-state workflow and approval flows

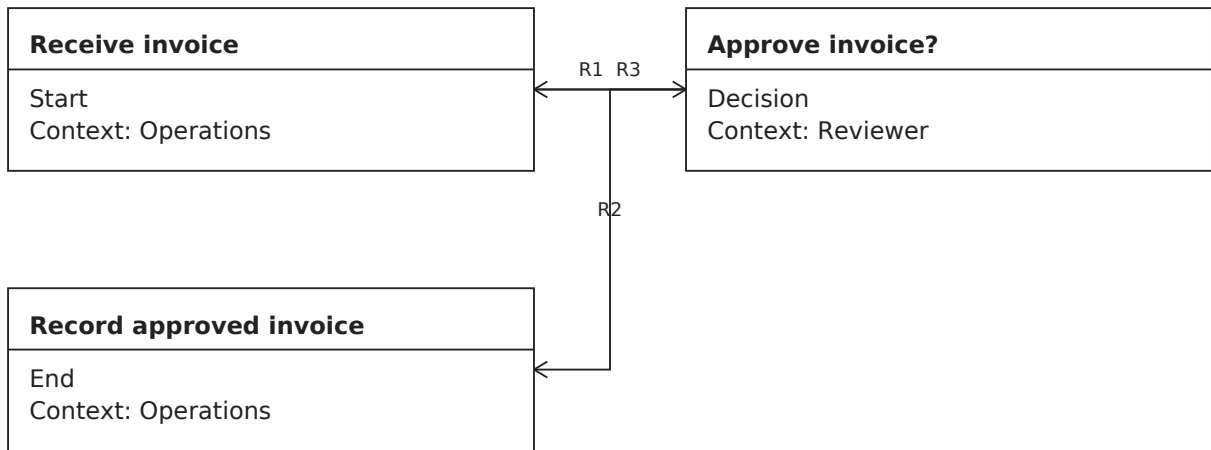


R1. Receive invoice — Approve invoice?: Validate

R2. Approve invoice? — Record approved invoice: Approved

R3. Approve invoice? — Receive invoice: Rejected: correct and resubmit

Future-state workflow and approval flows



R1. Receive invoice — Approve invoice?: Validate

R2. Approve invoice? — Record approved invoice: Approved

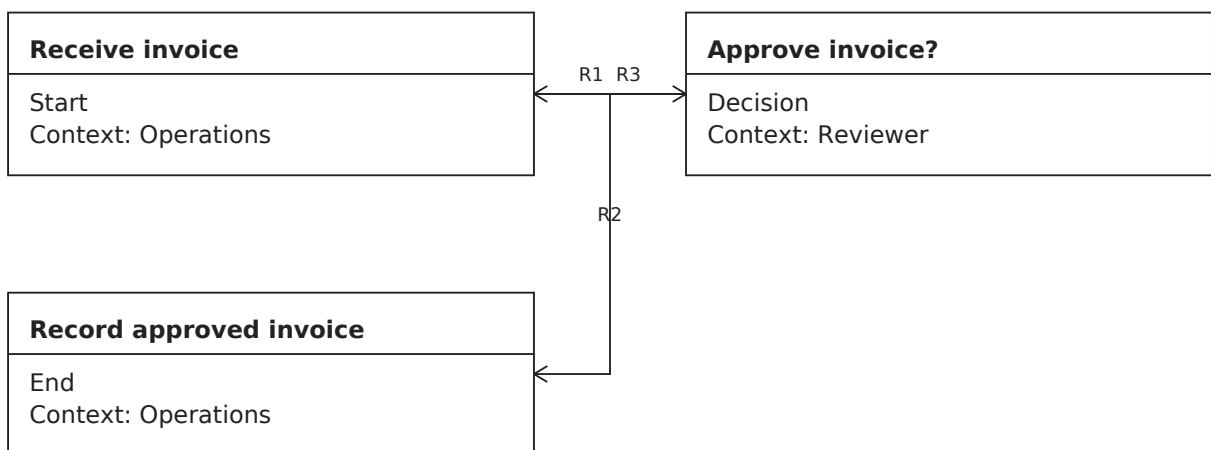
R3. Approve invoice? — Receive invoice: Rejected: correct and resubmit

18. User journeys, navigation and wireframes

User journeys and navigation: An operations user starts in the import queue, uploads a CSV, reviews exceptions and hands approved records to the reviewer. Failure returns the user to correction with row-specific guidance.

Key screen concepts: Use an import queue, exception review and audit history. All views need empty, loading, success and error states with accessible labels.

User journeys and navigation



R1. Receive invoice — Approve invoice?: Validate

R2. Approve invoice? — Record approved invoice: Approved

R3. Approve invoice? — Receive invoice: Rejected: correct and resubmit

User journeys and navigation

Design aspect	Detail
Goal / end state	Approved export is reconciled with the source invoice count.
Permissions / exceptions	Only reviewers approve; invalid files stay in correction and produce no export.

Import queue

Operations staff: Start an import and track progress.

Screen controls

Control	Purpose and behavior
Queue / New import / History	Navigate between upload, exceptions and audit history.
Invoice CSV	Choose a structured CSV; explain required columns and maximum file size.
Validate file	Disabled while validating; show an actionable error for malformed files.
Recent imports	File, submitted by, status, accepted and rejected rows. Empty: no imports yet.

Review exceptions

Operations reviewer: Resolve errors before approving export.

Screen controls

Control	Purpose and behavior
Invoice rows	Reference, amount, validation result and reason; highlight duplicate or missing fields.
Corrected value	Show validation feedback next to the field; retain the original value in the audit trail.
Approve export	Only reviewers can approve; block unresolved errors and show a confirmation summary.

Import history

Operations owner: Reconcile approved exports and inspect audit events.

Screen controls

Control	Purpose and behavior
Date and status	Filter completed, failed or pending imports.
Audit events	Invoice reference, actor, action, time and export identifier. Retry failures without duplicate export.
Reconciliation	Compare accepted source rows with exported rows; success requires matching counts and references.

19. Data model, ER diagram and database schema

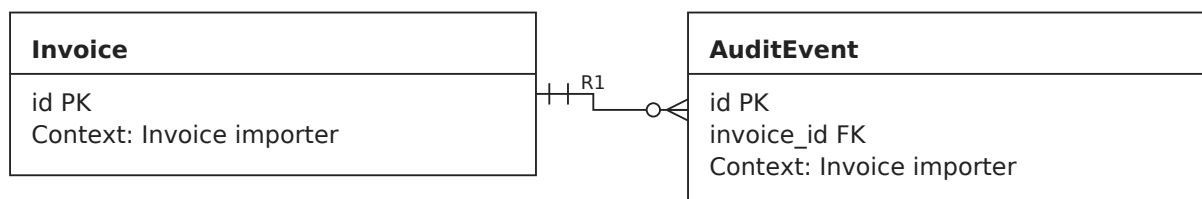
Data model and ER diagram: Invoice records have an immutable ID; each invoice can have many audit events. Keep the accounting record as the financial source of truth.

Database schema: Invoice stores validated business fields; audit events record who approved or rejected a row. Retention must be agreed before production.

- Structured invoice records

Data model and ER diagram

Entity relationship diagram. PK = primary key; FK = foreign key. A bar means one, a circle means optional, and a fork means many. Relationship references (R) identify the definitions below.



R1. Invoice — AuditEvent: 1 to 0..many; AuditEvent.invoice_id -> Invoice.id

Database schema

Design aspect	Detail
Invoice	id UUID PK; supplier_ref TEXT; invoice_ref TEXT; amount DECIMAL; status TEXT; created_at TIMESTAMP; unique supplier_ref + invoice_ref.
AuditEvent	id UUID PK; invoice_id UUID FK -> Invoice.id; actor_id TEXT; event TEXT; created_at TIMESTAMP; index(invoice_id, created_at).

Supporting specification: schema.sql (technical appendix).

20. REST API catalogue

Proposed internal API for the pilot; validate the final contract with implementers. No vendor API capability is assumed.

REST API catalogue

Design aspect	Detail
POST /imports	Reviewer-authenticated CSV upload; validates rows; returns import status and exception references. 400 malformed file, 403 access denied, 409 duplicate idempotency key.
GET /invoices	Operations role; paginated invoice status; response contains id, reference and status. 403 unauthorized, 503 store unavailable.

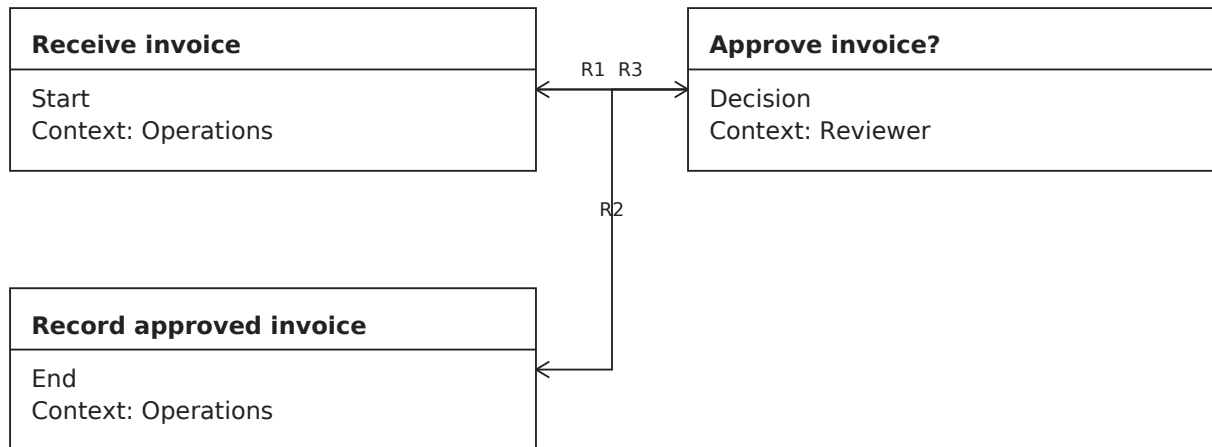
Supporting specification: openapi.yaml (technical appendix).

21. Integration architecture

Accounting CSV exchange is proposed pending format validation. Reconcile counts and references; never retry a completed export without checking its identifier.

- Accounting API access to be validated

Integration architecture



R1. Receive invoice — Approve invoice?: Validate

R2. Approve invoice? — Record approved invoice: Approved

R3. Approve invoice? — Receive invoice: Rejected: correct and resubmit

Integration architecture

Design aspect	Detail
Mapping / auth	Map invoice reference and amount to the approved accounting template; only the reviewer exports.
Failure / source of truth	Reject format mismatches; preserve source rows and reconcile against accounting.

22. Security, privacy and governance

Restrict invoice access to operations reviewers; record approvals and support access. Confirm retention, jurisdiction and accounting permissions before pilot.

Security, privacy and governance

Design aspect	Detail
Boundary	No payment credentials or automatic payment authorization.
Control	Encrypted transport, least-privilege access and auditable export approval.

23. Infrastructure, cloud and deployment architecture

Infrastructure and cloud architecture: Pilot in an isolated environment with bounded file storage, private database access and monitored job outcomes.

Deployment and release architecture: Validate in test, reconcile a representative sample, then promote an approved release. Operations owns go-live approval.

Infrastructure and cloud architecture

Design aspect	Detail
Backup / recovery	Agree recovery objectives, then test restoring the invoice audit trail.
Scale / secrets	Limit file size; keep credentials server-side in the approved secrets store.

Deployment and release architecture

Design aspect	Detail
CI/CD	Run schema and duplicate-handling checks before promotion.
Rollback	Stop new imports, retain audit data and return to reviewed manual entry.

24. Human checkpoints and operating model

Operations reviews exceptions and approves each export. The delivery engineer investigates failed jobs; the operations owner owns reconciliation.

- Review exceptions and approve imports

Human checkpoints and operating model

Design aspect	Detail
Checkpoint	Do not export until exceptions are resolved or explicitly excluded.

25. Implementation roadmap

Replace duplicate entry with reviewed imports.

01: Validate a small pilot

Actions	Ready when
Confirm import format Test duplicate handling	Pilot imports reconcile with source invoices

26. Effort, cost and resource estimates

Effort and cost estimates: Illustrative pilot: 10–20 person-days over 3–6 elapsed weeks, assuming one engineer and part-time operations review. Rates and vendor prices are unknown.

Resource plan: Assume one delivery engineer and a part-time operations reviewer; validate availability before scheduling.

- Implementation effort: 10–20 person-days. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: low. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.
- Elapsed duration: 3–6 weeks. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: low. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.
- Development/setup cost: Unknown — requires validation. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: unknown. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability

and rates with the operations owner.

- Recurring hosting/support: Unknown — requires validation. Basis: Illustrative planning assumption; no vendor quote or measured baseline supplied. Confidence: unknown. Assumptions: Confirm scope, staff availability and rates with the operations owner.

Effort and cost estimates

Design aspect	Detail
Validation	2–4 person-days (low confidence); confirm format and representative data.
Implementation / acceptance	8–16 person-days (low confidence); depends on access and reviewer availability.

Resource plan

Design aspect	Detail
Engineer	Implement validation, audit and deployment; 10–20 person-days, low-confidence assumption.
Operations owner	Confirm rules, sample reconciliation and go-live; involvement requires validation.

27. Timeline, milestones and sprint / release plan

Timeline and milestones: Tentative elapsed duration 3–6 weeks. External access and reviewer availability are critical dependencies, so no calendar dates are committed.

Sprint and release plan: Release by validation gate rather than unsupported fixed sprint dates.

Timeline and milestones

Design aspect	Detail
Week 1–2	Confirm data/format and pilot acceptance criteria.
Week 2–5	Implement and reconcile sample imports after format approval.
Week 3–6	Pilot, reconcile exports and approve go-live only after failure/rollback checks.

Sprint and release plan

Design aspect	Detail
MVP	CSV validation, duplicate checks and exception review.
Pilot	Approved export, audit history and sample reconciliation.
Rollout	Expand only after operations accepts results and rollback is exercised.

28. Migration, training and adoption

Train staff using sample invoices and exception cases. Reconcile any migrated open items, retain the old spreadsheet for an agreed period and review feedback weekly.

Migration, training and adoption

Design aspect	Detail
Measure adoption	Count completed imports, exceptions and manual re-entry before and after the pilot.

29. Success KPIs and business value

Less duplicate entry; savings must be measured.

- Track duplicate entry count before and after pilot

Business value estimates

Metric	Estimate / basis
Manual entry	Potential reduction, not yet quantified — No measured time baseline was supplied. (Assumption / estimate)

30. Feasibility and readiness assessment

Readiness remains advisory; the integration and baseline workload have not been validated.

Readiness assessment

Design aspect	Detail
Digital maturity	Developing — current spreadsheet workflow, no measured maturity baseline.
AI readiness	Unknown; no AI required for the selected scope.
Automation opportunity	Deterministic field validation and deduplication.
Project health	Planning stage; timeline assumptions pending confirmation.
Implementation readiness	Blocked on import format and representative data.
Solution quality	Requires reconciliation and failure/rollback testing.

Feasibility (advisory)

Dimension	Score / reason
Technical	75/100 — Validate access in a small pilot.
Data	75/100 — Validate access in a small pilot.
Integration	75/100 — Validate access in a small pilot.
Operational	75/100 — Validate access in a small pilot.
Business	75/100 — Validate access in a small pilot.
Overall	75/100

31. Risk register and mitigations

Mitigations are proposed controls; residual risks and validation actions remain visible.

Accounting import format unavailable

Risk field	Assessment
Severity	high
Likelihood	unknown
Impact	Blocks validated export.
Mitigation	Confirm a representative CSV import before implementing the handoff.
Owner	Operations owner
Validation Action	Reconcile a sample with accounting.
Residual Concern	Vendor changes may require remapping.

Accounting API access is not confirmed

Review field	Assessment
Category / severity	INTEGRATION / HIGH
Finding / impact	The supplied workflow names an accounting tool but no available API.
Mitigation	Validate API access before implementation; use a reviewed CSV import as fallback.
Status	Mitigation proposed; validate before implementation

32. Independent Red Team review and design changes

Confirm integration access before building.

Red Team cycle 1

Summary	Review scope
Confirm integration access before building.	Selected solution and all implementation design parts

Accounting API access is not confirmed

Review field	Assessment
Category / severity	INTEGRATION / HIGH
Finding / impact	The supplied workflow names an accounting tool but no available API.
Mitigation	Validate API access before implementation; use a reviewed CSV import as fallback.
Status	Mitigation proposed; validate before implementation

33. Final recommendation and immediate next actions

Pilot deterministic imports with staff review.

- Confirm integration access
- Measure the current workload

34. Appendix: assumptions, unresolved items, glossary and artifact index

Validate these assumptions and unresolved items before implementation. Design artifacts are proposals for review.

- Do not automate payments
- CSV import is supported; validate before implementation
- API access requires validation.
- Confirm accounting CSV format, retention period, baseline volume and rates.
- Idempotency: repeating a request does not duplicate its effect.

Generated artifact index

Section	Artifact
Current-state workflow	Current-state process map
High-level architecture	High-level architecture
Future-state workflow and approval flows	Future-state workflow and approval flows
Future-state workflow and approval flows	Future-state workflow and approval flows
User journeys, navigation and wireframes	User journeys and navigation
User journeys, navigation and wireframes	Import queue
User journeys, navigation and wireframes	Review exceptions
User journeys, navigation and wireframes	Import history
Data model, ER diagram and database schema	Data model and ER diagram
Data model, ER diagram and database schema	schema.sql
REST API catalogue	openapi.yaml
Integration architecture	Integration architecture

Technical appendix: implementation specifications

schema.sql

```
CREATE TABLE Invoice (  
  id UUID PRIMARY KEY,  
  supplier_ref TEXT NOT NULL,  
  invoice_ref TEXT NOT NULL,  
  amount DECIMAL(12,2) NOT NULL,  
  status TEXT NOT NULL,  
  created_at TIMESTAMP NOT NULL,  
  UNIQUE (supplier_ref, invoice_ref)  
);  
CREATE TABLE AuditEvent (  
  id UUID PRIMARY KEY,  
  invoice_id UUID NOT NULL REFERENCES Invoice(id),  
  actor_id TEXT NOT NULL,  
  event TEXT NOT NULL,  
  created_at TIMESTAMP NOT NULL  
);  
CREATE INDEX audit_invoice_time ON AuditEvent(invoice_id, created_at);
```

openapi.yaml

```
openapi: 3.0.3  
info:  
  title: Proposed invoice pilot API  
  version: 1.0.0  
security:  
  - sessionCookie: []  
paths:  
  /invoices:  
    get:  
      summary: List invoice status for authorized operations staff  
      parameters:  
        - in: query  
          name: page  
          schema: {type: integer, minimum: 1}  
      responses:  
        '200': {description: Paginated invoice IDs, references and status}  
        '403': {description: Operations role required}  
        '503': {description: Audit store unavailable}  
  /imports:  
    post:  
      summary: Validate CSV rows for an authorized reviewer  
      parameters:  
        - in: header  
          name: Idempotency-Key  
          required: true  
          schema: {type: string}  
      requestBody:  
        required: true  
        content:  
          text/csv:  
            schema: {type: string}  
      responses:  
        '200': {description: Import status and exception references}  
        '400': {description: Malformed file or invalid fields}  
        '403': {description: Reviewer role required}  
        '409': {description: Idempotency key conflicts with another payload}  
components:  
  securitySchemes:  
    sessionCookie:  
      type: apiKey  
      in: cookie  
      name: session
```